Elisa Maria Wirsching

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Appointments

London School of Economics and Political Science
Assistant Professor in Political Science and Public Policy 2025–

Princeton University, School of Public and International Affairs
Postdoctoral Fellow at the Center for the Study of Democratic Politics (CSDP) 2024–2025

Education

New York University
Ph.D. in Politics 2019–2024

- Dissertation: "Essays on the Politics of Local Bureaucracies"
- Winner of Dean's Outstanding Dissertation Award (GSAS, NYU); Ronald H. Coase Best Dissertation Award (SIOE); Best Dissertation Award (APSA Urban and Local Politics Section)
- Committee: Hye Young You (Chair), Sanford Gordon, Julia Payson, Tara Slough, Arthur Spirling

London School of Economics and Political Science
MSc Political Science and Political Economy, with distinction 2016–2017

University of Mannheim
BA Political Science, Minor: Economics, with distinction 2013–2016

Research Interests

Substantive: American Political Institutions, Bureaucratic Politics, Local Politics, Political Economy

Methodological: Natural Experiments, Spatial Data, Text Data

Publications

[1] K. Heo and E. M. Wirsching, "Bureaucratic Resistance and Policy Inefficiency", *American Political Science Review*, 2026. DOI: 10.1017/S0003055426101609.

[2] E. M. Wirsching, "Political Power of Bureaucratic Agents: Evidence from Policing in New York City", *The Journal of Politics*, 2026. DOI: 10.1086/742023.

[3] E. M. Wirsching, "Sorting for K-Street: Post-Employment Regulations and Strategic Wage Setting in Congress", *The Journal of Politics*, vol. 87, no. 2, pp. 664–679, 2025. DOI: 10.1086/732988.

[4] E. M. Wirsching, P. L. Rodriguez, A. Spirling, and B. M. Stewart, "Multilanguage Word Embeddings for Social Scientists: Estimation, Inference, and Validation Resources for 157 Languages", *Political Analysis*, pp. 1–8, 2024. DOI: 10.1017/pan.2024.17.

Working Papers & Work in Progress

"The Limits of Merit: Career Pipelines and Representation in US Law Enforcement" *R&R at the APSR*

- APSA 2024 Best Paper Award, Urban and Local Politics Section

"Cultural Conflicts, Professional Identity, and Workforce Sorting: Evidence from U.S. Public School Employees" *(with Roxanne Rahnama and Tyler Simko)*

"The Political Consequences of Police Slowdowns" *(with Arvind Krishnamurthy and Dvir Yogev)*

"The Revolving Door for Political Elites: Policymakers' Professional Background and Financial Regulation" *(EBRD Working Paper 222, 2018)*

Grants & Scholarships

Department of Government Seed Grant (LSE)	2026
Research & Innovation Grant (LSE)	2026
Urban Doctoral Fellowship (New York University)	2023
George Downs Grant (New York University)	2022, 2023
MacCracken Fellowship (New York University)	2019–2024
DAAD Carlo-Schmid Fellowship (German Academic Exchange Service)	2017–2018
DAAD Graduate Scholarship (German Academic Exchange Service)	2016–2017
Study Scholarship (German National Academic Foundation)	2013–2017

Awards

LPEC Best Poster Award	2026
Best Dissertation Award (APSA Urban and Local Politics Section)	2025
Ronald H. Coase Dissertation Award (Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics)	2025
Dean's Outstanding Dissertation Award (New York University)	2025
Virginia Gray Graduate Research Award (APSA POP section)	2022
PolMeth Travel and Participation Award (Political Methodology Society, declined)	2022
Youth ResearchEdge Winner (OECD Anti-Corruption & Integrity Forum)	2017
MSc PSPE Prize for Best Dissertation (London School of Economics)	2017
Best Overall Performance, BA Political Science (ABSOLVENTUM Mannheim)	2016

Presentations

Invited Talks & Workshops

EUI (CPSS Seminar); UCL (Departmental Research Seminar); EUI (Workshop on the Global Challenges of Local Politics); Trinity College Dublin (Departmental Research Seminar)	2026
Kings College London (DPE Seminar); Bocconi University (P&I Seminar); Kings College London (Public Policy and Regulation Workshop); Columbia University (Political Economy Seminar); Princeton University (Conference on Local Political Institutions, Bureaucracy, and Interest Groups); Yale University (CSAP American Politics Conference)	2025
Princeton University (CSDP Colloquium); Quality of Government Institute (Gothenburg University); Princeton-SNU Summer Institute; UChicago (Conference on Presidential Power, the Administrative State, and American Democracy)	2024

American University (Department of Government); University of Texas at Austin (LBJ School of Public Affairs); University of Virginia (Frank Batten School of Leadership & Public Policy); Indiana University Bloomington (Department of Political Science); University of California San Diego (Department of Political Science); London School of Economics and Political Science (Government Department); University of Rochester (Department of Political Science); MIT (Department of Political Science); European University Institute (Department of Political and Social Sciences); Aarhus University (Department of Political Science); Northeast Workshop in Empirical Political Science (NEWEPS) 20; NYU-LSE Conference on Political Economy — 2023

European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (Office of the Chief Economist, Speaker Series); Local Political Economy APSA Pre-Conference; CBS (Money in Politics Conference); Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop; Text-as-Data (TADA) Annual Conference — 2022

2018 OECD Anti-Corruption and Integrity Forum; 7th Mannheim Energy Conference; 2018 Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association (Workshop on Political Economy); 2018 NICEP Conference — 2016–2019

Annual Meetings

American Political Science Association: 2021–2026

Midwest Political Science Association: 2023–2024

European Political Science Society: 2026

European Political Science Association: 2021, 2025

Society for Political Methodology: 2022

Teaching

Policy Analysis and Policy Advice — 2026-27
Course Convenor

Approaches and Issues in Public Policy and Administration — 2025-26; 2026-27
Course Convenor: Prof. Daniel Berliner

Text as Data (graduate) — Spring 2023
TA for Prof. Arthur Spirling

Quantitative Methods III (graduate) — Fall 2022, Spring 2024
TA for Prof. Tara Slough

Power and Politics in America (undergraduate) — Spring 2022
TA for Prof. Chris Dawes

Introduction to Research Methods (undergraduate) — Fall 2021
TA for Prof. Hye Young You

Experience

NYU Public Safety Lab — New York, NY
Graduate Research Affiliate — 2021–present

NYU, Research Assistant — New York, NY
Research Assistant for Prof. Arthur Spirling — 2021–2022
Research Assistant for Prof. Dimitri Landa — 2021
Research Assistant for Prof. Hye Young You — 2020

University of Mannheim, Chair of Econometrics — Lusaka, ZM
Research Associate for Prof. Markus Frölich — 2018–2019

European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD) — London, UK
Analyst at the Office of the Chief Economist — 2017–2018

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW) — Mannheim, DE
Intern at the Research Group "International Distribution and Redistribution" — 2016

EU Office of the Friedrich-Ebert-Foundation (FES) — Brussels, BE
Seminar Assistant — 2015–2016

Collaborative Research Centre 884 — Mannheim, DE
Research Assistant for Prof. Thomas König & Prof. Nicole Rae Baerg — 2014–2016

Relevant Skills

Computing Skills: R, Stata, Stan, LaTeX, Python, SQL

Languages: German (native), English (near native), Spanish (advanced), French (basic)

Professional Service

Co-Organizer: NEWEPS-18 (2022), NYU Politics Department Women's Informal Network (2022-2023), Behavioral Political Economy Workshop 2027

Reviewer: Journal of Politics; American Journal of Political Science; American Political Science Review; Political Analysis; Urban Affairs Review; Political Behavior